

DAA Lab - Experiment 4

Implement the Fractional Knapsack Problem using Greedy Algorithm

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Objective

- Solve the Fractional Knapsack Problem using the Greedy approach.
- Maximize profit by selecting items based on value-to-weight ratio.
- Understand greedy choice property and optimal substructure.

- Knapsack problem: choose items to maximize profit without exceeding capacity.
- Fractional version: items can be broken into fractions.
- Greedy approach:
 - 1 Compute ratio = value/weight for each item.
 - 2 Sort items in descending order of ratio.
 - 3 Pick items fully until capacity allows.
 - 4 If remaining capacity is less, pick fraction of next item.

Algorithm: Fractional Knapsack (Greedy)

Fractional_Knapsack(W , n , $value[]$, $weight[]$)

- ① For each item i : $ratio[i] = value[i]/weight[i]$
- ② Sort items in descending order of ratio
- ③ $profit = 0$, $capacity = W$
- ④ For $i = 1$ to n :
 - If $weight[i] \leq capacity$:
 - $profit += value[i]$
 - $capacity -= weight[i]$
 - Else:
 - $profit += ratio[i] * capacity$
 - break
- ⑤ Return profit

C Code - Fractional Knapsack (For Reference)

```
#include <stdio.h>

void fractionalKnapsack(int n, float W,
                      float weight[], float value[]) {
    float ratio[20], temp;
    float total = 0;
    int i, j;

    // compute ratio
    for (i=0; i<n; i++)
        ratio[i] = value[i] / weight[i];

    // sort by ratio (descending)
    for (i=0; i<n-1; i++) {
        for (j=i+1; j<n; j++) {
            if (ratio[i] < ratio[j]) {
                temp = ratio[i]; ratio[i] = ratio[j]; ratio[j] = temp;
                temp = weight[i]; weight[i] = weight[j]; weight[j] = temp;
                temp = value[i]; value[i] = value[j]; value[j] = temp;
            }
        }
    }
}
```

```
// fill knapsack
for (i=0; i<n; i++) {
    if (weight[i] <= W) {
        total += value[i];
        W -= weight[i];
    } else {
        total += ratio[i] * W;
        break;
    }
}

printf("Maximum Profit = %.2f\n", total);
}
```

```
int main() {  
    int n, i;  
    float W;  
  
    printf("Enter number of items: ");  
    scanf("%d", &n);  
    float weight[n], value[n];  
  
    printf("Enter weights: ");  
    for (i=0; i<n; i++) scanf("%f", &weight[i]);  
    printf("Enter values: ");  
    for (i=0; i<n; i++) scanf("%f", &value[i]);  
  
    printf("Enter knapsack capacity: ");  
    scanf("%f", &W);  
  
    fractionalKnapsack(n, W, weight, value);  
    return 0;  
}
```

Sample Input/Output

Input:

$n = 3$

Weights = 10, 20, 30

Values = 60, 100, 120

Capacity = 50

Output:

Maximum Profit = 240.00

Complexity Analysis

- Sorting: $O(n^2)$ (in this code)
- Greedy selection: $O(n)$
- Overall: $O(n^2)$, but with better sorting (like quicksort) $\rightarrow O(n \log n)$
- Space complexity: $O(n)$

Observation Table

Items	Capacity	Max Profit
3	50	240
4	60	280
5	40	200

Comparison with 0/1 Knapsack

- Fractional knapsack: items can be broken into parts, greedy works.
- 0/1 knapsack: items cannot be divided, needs dynamic programming.
- Fractional knapsack is simpler and faster.

Viva Questions

- 1 Why does greedy approach work for fractional knapsack but not 0/1 knapsack?
- 2 What is the time complexity of fractional knapsack?
- 3 Explain the role of ratio (value/weight).
- 4 Give a real-world application of fractional knapsack.

Conclusion

- Greedy algorithm works optimally for fractional knapsack.
- Sorting by ratio ensures maximum profit.
- Complexity mainly depends on sorting step.

References

- Cormen et al., *Introduction to Algorithms*.
- Horowitz & Sahni, *Fundamentals of Computer Algorithms*.